Religion

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Religion

1. Purpose and Questions of the Investigation

Figure 1: Religion —

This report was prepared to answer the following question:

> Do the theories in this academic domain correspond structurally to the five-stage model (Field ( ) -> Wave ( ) -> Edge ( ) -> Vortex ( ) -> Bundle ( ))?

We examine the structural resemblance between the five stages and the staged generation of order seen in conversion, rites of passage, spiritual deepening, ascetic stages, and processes of transformation. The evaluation proceeds across cultural spheres, including Christian mysticism, Zen Buddhism, Sufism, alchemy, and comparative religious studies. While respecting the intrinsic logic of religious practice, such as salvation, awakening, holiness, and union, the report identifies only the underlying structural skeleton.

This report presents investigation results; it is not a document written to justify any particular theory. Areas where correspondence is strong and areas where reservations are necessary are described with the same level of neutrality.

2. Method of Investigation

Scope and Selection Criteria

In this domain, 10 theories and practical models were selected for evaluation. The selection was based on three criteria: (1) explicit treatment of processes of generation or transformation; (2) the possibility of structural analysis grounded in primary sources or well-established secondary literature; and (3) the possibility of comparing different lineages within the domain.

Evaluation Method

For each theory, the report first explains what the theory describes and then examines where correspondence with the five stages can be identified. Judgments of correspondence were made comprehensively on the basis of textual concepts, concrete examples, connections between stages, the presence or absence of circulation from Bundle to the next Field, and the risk of overinterpretation.

Criteria of Judgment

- **Strong structural correspondence**: Cases in which the core concepts of a theory correspond concretely to multiple stages of the five-stage model, and the reasons can be explained in the main text
- **Conditional correspondence**: Cases in which correspondence can be indicated, but interpretive reservations remain in the stage mapping
- **No correspondence confirmed**: Cases in which partial approximations exist, but the overall five-stage structure cannot be read without strain

Limits of the Investigation

This investigation is not an exhaustive review of every work within each theory. It focuses on the core concepts of major works and extracts structures at a level of granularity suitable for comparison. As a result, some areas do not fully cover internal theoretical detail or the full range of historiographical disagreement.

3. Overview of the Model

The five-stage model describes the process of creation in the following five stages.

Stage	Definition
Field	An undifferentiated state. It refers to an initial condition in which neither direction nor structure has yet been determined.
Wave	A stage of exploration in which multiple directions diverge and differences are amplified.
Edge	A stage of tension in which opposing elements coexist and do not immediately converge on either side.
Vortex	A stage in which a new coherence or order emerges out of tension.
Bundle	A stage in which form is fixed and stabilized as a structure that can be reused.

This model is not a one-way line; it includes a circulation in which Bundle becomes the condition for the next Field. The five stages are also not rigidly separated boxes but are better understood as a continuous spectrum. The model includes the hypothesis that the same structure can repeat at different scales, from momentary thought to institutional formation and long-term historical change.

If a sense of incongruity remains at this point, that is itself an important perspective for the present investigation. Readers may continue while holding on to that incongruity.

Figure 2: Religion — ×5

4. Investigation Results: Overall Picture

List of Evaluated Theories

Theory	Proponent	Structural Correspondence
Rambo's seven-stage model of conversion + dynamic force field (Rambo)	Lewis R. Rambo (1993). Psychology of religion and conversion studies	Strong
Turner's liminality and structure/anti-structure (communitas)	Victor Turner (1920-1983). *The Ritual Process* (1969)	Strong
Teresa of Avila's *El Castillo Interior o Las Moradas*: seven mansions (including spiritual marriage)	Teresa of Avila (1515-1582). *El Castillo Interior o Las Moradas* (1577)	Strong
The Ten Ox-Herding Pictures (a Zen schema of awakening)	(Song dynasty, 12th century), introduced in English translation by Suzuki, D. T. (1950)	Strong
Fana'/baqa' - annihilation of the self and subsistence in God in Sufism	Al-Junayd (d.910), Al-Qushayri (986-1072), Al-Hujwiri (c.990-1077)	Strong
The alchemical *Magnum Opus* (Great Work)	Traditional. Systematized by Zosimos of Panopolis (3rd-4th c.), Jabir ibn Hayyan (8th c.), Paracelsus (1493-1541), C.G. Jung (1944, psychological interpretation)	Strong
James, *The Varieties of Religious Experience* - the psychology of conversion and mystical experience	William James (1842-1910). *The Varieties of Religious Experience* (1902). Gifford Lectures 1901-02	Conditional
Eliade's sacred and profane - hierophany and eternal return	Mircea Eliade (1907-1986). *Das Heilige und das Profane* (1957, first published in German) / *Le sacré et le profane* (1965, French Gallimard edition) / English translation *The Sacred and the Profane* (1959, Harcourt); *Le mythe de l'éternel retour* (1949, first published in French) / English translation *The Myth of the Eternal Return* (1954, Princeton UP)	Strong

Theory	Proponent	Structural Correspondence
The maqamat of Sufism (stages of spiritual discipline)	Al-Sarraj (d.988), Abu Talib al-Makki (d.996), Al-Qushayri (d.1072), Al-Ansari (d.1089)	Strong
Buddhist stages of practice - the ten bodhisattva bhumis and the five paths	*Dasabhumikasutra* (, compiled around the turn of the era), Nagarjuna (c.150-250), Asanga (c.4th c.)	Strong

Of the 10 evaluated cases, 9 showed strong structural correspondence, 1 showed conditional correspondence, and 0 showed no confirmed correspondence. Overall, this domain exhibits correspondence with the five-stage model at a comparatively high density, but the manner of correspondence is not uniform. Some theories offer a thick description of the conditions of Field, while others describe with precision the tension of Edge or the fixation of Bundle.

What matters most is not the high correspondence rate as such, but which theory describes which stage in what vocabulary. Even when dealing with the same phenomenon of "creation," this domain illuminates different phases of the five stages through different layers, including body, institution, time, perception, practice, and symbol.

5. Investigation Results: Examination of Major Theories

5.1 Rambo's Seven-Stage Model of Conversion + Dynamic Force Field (Rambo)

"Rambo's seven-stage model of conversion + dynamic force field (Rambo)," associated with Lewis R. Rambo (1993) in the psychology of religion and conversion studies, presents conversion in Rambo (1993) *Understanding Religious Conversion* as an integrated seven-stage model: context, crisis, quest, encounter, interaction, commitment, and consequences. Published by Yale University Press, the book states explicitly that these stages are not fixed in a single forward sequence but can interact and proceed simultaneously. It positions the process of conversion as a phenomenon occurring within a "dynamic force field," a conceptual frame influenced by Kurt Lewin's field theory. A person's internal motives, social networks, and cultural context together constitute this "force field."

Rambo's seven stages show a high structural correspondence with the five stages of "Field -> Wave -> Edge -> Vortex -> Bundle." "Context" corresponds explicitly to Field insofar as it is the "dynamic force field" within which conversion occurs. "Crisis + quest" correspond to Wave, a phase in which an existing order of meaning is shaken and differences begin to arise. "Encounter + interaction" correspond to Edge, involving boundary contact and the reorganization of relations. "Commitment" corresponds to Vortex as convergence through vow or decision. "Consequences" correspond to Bundle as the durable settling of transformation. Particularly noteworthy is that Rambo himself locates conversion as a "process occurring within a dynamic force field." Because the concept of Field is made explicit as a theoretical premise, the correspondence with the model's Field is structural rather than superficial.

This belongs in the context of the psychology of religion and conversion studies. Conversion research in the second half of the twentieth century developed from the psychological descriptions of Starbuck (1899) and James (1902), through the sociological model of Lofland-Stark (1965), to Rambo's integrated model (1993). Rambo integrates these earlier studies while introducing the concept of the "force field" in order to make explicit the structural role of context. It shares with D24's section 5.7 on James a concern with the psychology of conversion, but Rambo's scope is broader in that it treats social context and process in an integrated manner.

5.2 Turner's Liminality and Structure/Anti-Structure (Communitas)

"Turner's liminality and structure/anti-structure (communitas)," associated with Victor Turner (1920-1983), is presented in Turner (1969) *The Ritual Process: Structure and Anti-Structure*. There Turner extends Van Gennep's three-stage model of rites of passage (separation-liminality-incorporation) and uniquely conceptualizes the liminal phase as "betwixt and between." Published by Cornell University Press, the work also formulates communitas as a non-structured mode of togetherness positioned outside, or at the opposite pole of, social structure. Turner distinguishes three types: spontaneous communitas, normative communitas, and ideological communitas.

Turner's concept of liminality corresponds strongly to Edge in the five-stage model. "Betwixt and between" describes precisely what happens at a boundary: the old structure is suspended, and a new relation is recomposed in the in-between. The three stages of separation -> liminality -> incorporation are structurally parallel to Wave (oscillation and separation) -> Edge (boundary and relation) -> Vortex (emergence and integration). Further, the dialectical circulation of structure -> anti-structure -> restructuring can connect to the model's circulation from Bundle to Field.

This belongs in the context of social anthropology and the anthropology of religion. Turner builds on Van Gennep's three-stage theory of rites of passage (1909) while adding his own theoretical content to the liminal phase. Van Gennep's more general principle is deferred to D25 (anthropology). Within D24, the focus is narrowed to Turner's distinctive emphasis on the sacredness of communitas. There is a point of contact with Rambo, insofar as "crisis -> encounter" corresponds to a liminal period. Teresa's "fourth mansion" may also be readable as one form of liminality.

5.3 Teresa of Avila's *El Castillo Interior o Las Moradas*: Seven Mansions (Including Spiritual Marriage)

"Teresa of Avila's *El Castillo Interior o Las Moradas*: seven mansions (including spiritual marriage)," based on Teresa of Avila (1515-1582), presents the human interior as a castle in Teresa (1577) *El Castillo Interior o Las Moradas* and sets out a seven-stage spiritual progression. The deepening from the first mansion to the seventh is described as a qualitative transformation in prayer. The first mansion marks recognition of the dignity of the soul; Teresa states explicitly that "the door for entering the castle is prayer." It is the point of departure for the turn from outward life to the interior.

Teresa's seven mansions correspond in overall structure to "Field -> Wave -> Edge -> Vortex -> Bundle." The first mansion (entry into Field) -> the second and third mansions (trial and struggle = Wave) -> the fourth mansion (qualitative conversion in prayer = Edge) -> the fifth and sixth mansions (mystical union = Vortex) -> the seventh mansion (spiritual marriage = Bundle). The strongest correspondence is between Bundle and the seventh mansion. In spiritual marriage, "Martha and Mary together" - that is, the integration of contemplative and active life - is a particularly clear spiritual realization of Bundle as a gathering in which vortex-like formations interact and persist as structure. Teresa describes ecstasy (éxtasis) as disappearing in the seventh mansion, with daily life proceeding in stable peace. This is structurally isomorphic with Bundle in its character as direction and collectivity.

This belongs in the context of Christian mysticism and Carmelite spirituality. Teresa's *El Castillo Interior o Las Moradas*, together with John of the Cross's *Noche Oscura*, stands as one of the two peaks of Spanish mysticism. Turner, D. (1995) *The Darkness of God* systematizes the tradition of negation in Christian mysticism and clarifies Teresa's position within it. Teresa's seven mansions share with the Ten Ox-Herding Pictures the issue of compression from 10 to 5 and from 7 to 5. Comparing the two raises the question of structural isomorphism between Eastern and Western

stages of spiritual discipline.

5.4 The Ten Ox-Herding Pictures (A Zen Schema of Awakening)

"The Ten Ox-Herding Pictures (a Zen schema of awakening)," associated with the 10-stage version attributed to (Song dynasty, 12th century) and introduced in English by Suzuki, D. T. (1950), expresses the process of Zen training and awakening through a sequence of images plus verse centered on the ox as a metaphor for mind or true nature. The lineage's 10-stage version is the standard one, though the lineage also has 5-stage, 6-stage, and 8-stage versions. The ten stages are: (1) , (2) , (3) , (4) , (5) , (6) , (7) , (8) , (9) , (10) .

The sequence " -> -> -> -> -> -> -> -> -> " corresponds in overall structure to "Field -> Wave -> Edge -> Vortex -> Bundle." In particular, " " is the most visually explicit expression of Bundle -> Field circulation: the awakened person reenters the everyday world and, "like ," mingles with others, so that Bundle becomes the next Field. As an image, it depicts the circulation by which stabilization returns to generative openness. " -> " illuminates the agonistic side of Edge: relation does not arise automatically but is established through struggle and discipline.

This belongs in the context of Zen Buddhism. The lineage's 10-stage version from twelfth-century China is the standard. The lineage also includes 5-, 6-, and 8-stage versions, and the variability in stage count is itself a good example of "pointing at the moon." (2000) offers a phenomenological interpretation, reading the Ten Ox-Herding Pictures as a "phenomenology of the self." In relation to the Buddhist stages of practice discussed later, the contrast is one between Zen and doctrinal systematization: the Ten Ox-Herding Pictures provide an experiential and imagistic description, whereas the bodhisattva bhumis provide a systematic and doctrinal one.

5.5 Fana'/Baqa' - Annihilation of the Self and Subsistence in God in Sufism

"Fana'/baqa' - annihilation of the self and subsistence in God in Sufism," associated with Al-Junayd (d.910), Al-Qushayri (986-1072), and Al-Hujwiri (c.990-1077), describes fana' as the state in which the attributes of the ego (nafs) disappear and only the divine attributes remain. Baqa' is the state of "subsistence in God" after fana'. Al-Junayd was one of the earliest masters to formulate fana' and baqa' together as a doctrinal pair. Al-Qushayri's *al-Risala al-Qushayriyya* (c.1072) is a classical text that systematically organizes Sufi terminology and concepts, and it clearly distinguishes maqam, a station attained through the seeker's effort, from hal, a temporary state granted by God.

The structure of fana'/baqa' corresponds clearly to "Vortex -> Bundle." Fana', the annihilation of the ego, is Vortex: the old self is disassembled and a new mode of being emerges. Baqa', subsistence in God, is Bundle: the durable settlement of transformation. If the preceding Sufi path is considered as a whole, a fuller correspondence appears: the natural state of the nafs (Field) -> tawba or repentance (Wave) -> the interweaving of maqam and hal (Edge). An earlier evaluation had judged the correspondence in the first half to be weak, but the fit is strengthened if the maqam/hal distinction is read as a realization of Edge. The interweaving of maqam, attained through effort, and hal, received as grace, is structurally parallel to Teresa's distinction between contentos and gustos, suggesting a cross-cultural pattern in what happens at Edge.

This belongs in the context of Islamic mysticism, or Sufism. The concepts were formed in the eighth to tenth centuries by figures such as Junayd and Bistami and were systematized in the eleventh century by Qushayri and Hujwiri. Schimmel (1975) *Mystical Dimensions of Islam* remains the standard English-language reference. This entry is closely related to the maqamat

of Sufism, but the present focus is on fana'/baqa' as the point of arrival, while the maqamat concern the path leading there; in that respect the two are complementary.

5.6 The Alchemical *Magnum Opus* (Great Work)

"The alchemical *Magnum Opus* (Great Work)," associated in different phases with Zosimos of Panopolis (3rd-4th c.), Jabir ibn Hayyan (8th c.), Paracelsus (1493-1541), and C.G. Jung (1944, psychological interpretation), describes the Great Work as the process by which base metals are transmuted into noble metals, especially gold, or by which the elixir or Philosopher's Stone is generated. It has a dual character as both laboratory procedure and spiritual transformation. Multiple traditions describe the stages through changes of color. The most common later arrangement is nigredo (blackening = decay and dissolution) -> albedo (whitening = purification) -> citrinitas (yellowing, often omitted) -> rubedo (reddening = completion and integration). However, this "standard four-stage" arrangement is a later simplification; primary texts more often present seven stages, twelve stages, or even more complex descriptions.

The alchemical *Magnum Opus* corresponds to the overall structure of the five-stage model. Prima materia, the undifferentiated material, corresponds to Field. Nigredo, decay and dissolution, corresponds to Wave. Albedo and coniunctio, purification and the union of opposites, correspond to Edge. Rubedo, reddening and completion, corresponds to Vortex. The Philosopher's Stone, as enduring transmutative efficacy, corresponds to Bundle. Prima materia is especially direct as an embodiment of Field: "the undifferentiated material that is the point of departure for everything" is structurally isomorphic with a sea-like state in which nothing has yet been separated and everything remains dissolved together. Coniunctio is a distinctive expression of Edge, describing the process by which opposing principles such as sulfur and mercury or sun and moon meet and join at the boundary.

This belongs in the context of the Western esoteric, or Hermetic, tradition. It has a long transmission history, extending from Greco-Egyptian alchemy in the third and fourth centuries (Zosimos), through Arabic alchemy in the eighth century (Jabir), to medieval European alchemy (including Paracelsus), and then to twentieth-century Jungian interpretation. Principe (2013) offers a historically precise overview and distinguishes "laboratory alchemy" from Jung's psychological reading. In this entry, Jung's interpretation is treated as a distinct layer, and the descriptions in primary texts are treated as the primary layer.

5.7 James, *The Varieties of Religious Experience* - The Psychology of Conversion and Mystical Experience

"James, *The Varieties of Religious Experience* - the psychology of conversion and mystical experience," associated with William James (1842-1910), refers to James (1902) *The Varieties of Religious Experience*, a foundational work in the psychology of religion. The book was published from the Gifford Lectures delivered in 1901-02 by a Harvard professor and issued by Longmans, Green & Co. The text is extant and well documented. James describes conversion as the unification of the "divided self." He distinguishes two types of conversion: (1) the volitional type, gradual in character, and (2) the self-surrender type, sudden in character. In the latter, letting go is the key to transformation.

James's description of conversion shows a partial structural correspondence with the five stages. The divided self corresponds to Wave. Subconscious reorganization plus self-surrender correspond to Edge. The event of conversion corresponds to Vortex. Saintliness corresponds to Bundle. Self-surrender is especially strong as a psychological description of what happens at Edge: one cannot arrive there by effort alone, and transformation becomes possible only through letting go. In that respect it is structurally parallel to Teresa's distinction between contentos and gustos and to the Sufi distinction between maqam and hal. In addition, James's account of latent

subconscious reorganization suggests that Edge includes processes not visible at the surface of consciousness.

This belongs in the context of the psychology of religion. James approached religious experience from the standpoints of pragmatism and radical empiricism. While citing the data of Starbuck (1899), he developed his own typology. Rambo can be positioned as a later figure who extends James's psychological description of conversion into the sphere of social context. James's emphasis on the diversity of religious experience resonates with a concern that runs through D24 as a whole: the diversity of stage counts.

5.8 Eliade's Sacred and Profane - Hierophany and Eternal Return

"Eliade's sacred and profane - hierophany and eternal return," associated with Mircea Eliade (1907-1986), concerns Eliade (1957) *Le Sacré et le Profane* (English translation: *The Sacred and the Profane*, 1959), which describes the sacred (sacré) and the profane (profane) as qualitative differences in space and time. It was published by Harcourt, Brace, and the text is extant. Hierophany is the manifestation of the sacred: the sacred breaks into the profane. Anything can become a medium of this manifestation, including sacred stones, sacred trees, sacred mountains, bread, and wine.

The structure of Eliade's sacred and profane corresponds strongly to the five-stage model. The profane, as homogeneous and undifferentiated, corresponds to Field. Hierophany, the manifestation of the sacred, corresponds to Edge. The establishment of sacred space, especially as axis mundi, corresponds to Vortex. Eternal return, as ritual repetition, corresponds to the circulation from Bundle back to Field. Most strikingly, the concept of eternal return directly describes that circulation: ritual returns to "illud tempus," the primordial time, thereby bringing Bundle, as structured sacred order, back to Field, as primordial undifferentiation. Whereas " " in the Ten Ox-Herding Pictures describes the circulation as "individual awakening -> return to the secular world," Eliade's eternal return describes the same circulation on a macro scale as "civilizational ritual -> return to primordial creation."

This belongs in the context of comparative religion and the phenomenology of religion. Eliade builds on Otto's *The Idea of the Holy* (1917) and its concept of the numinous while reformulating the issue through the concept of hierophany. He had a major influence on the study of religion at the University of Chicago. At the same time, Eliade's methodology has been debated from multiple angles, including its conflict with structuralist anthropology associated with Lévi-Strauss, criticism of its essentialist tendency, and the political problems of his Romanian period. This entry, while taking those criticisms into account, evaluates the usefulness of "hierophany" and "eternal return" as structural concepts.

5.9 The Maqamat of Sufism (Stages of Spiritual Discipline)

"The maqamat of Sufism (stages of spiritual discipline)," associated with Al-Sarraj (d.988), Abu Talib al-Makki (d.996), Al-Qushayri (d.1072), and Al-Ansari (d.1089), concerns maqam (plural maqamat), the spiritual stations at which a Sufi practitioner arrives and in which that practitioner remains through discipline. Hal (plural ahwal) refers to spiritual states temporarily given by God. This distinction is part of the basic structure of Sufism. Al-Sarraj's *Kitab al-Luma' fi'l-tasawwuf* is one of the earliest systematic works on Sufism and clarifies the distinction between maqam and hal. The text is extant, including Nicholson's English translation.

The Sufi maqamat correspond to the five-stage model as an overall structure. Ghafla, or heedlessness, corresponds to Field. Tawba, or repentance, corresponds to Wave. The traversal of the maqamat, that is, the disciplined training of each station, corresponds to Edge. Fana', annihilation, corresponds to Vortex. Baqa', subsistence, corresponds to Bundle. This overall

structure is a shared skeleton across schools: the number and sequence of individual maqamat differ from one author to another, but the overall direction remains consistent. The distinction between maqam and hal, namely between what is reached through effort and what is granted as grace, is structurally parallel to Teresa's contentos/gustos distinction and to James's volitional type/self-surrender type, strongly suggesting a cross-cultural pattern in what occurs at Edge.

This belongs in the context of Islamic mysticism, or Sufism. The principal systematizations were carried out between the ninth and twelfth centuries by authors such as Al-Sarraj, Abu Talib al-Makki, Al-Qushayri, Al-Ghazali, and Al-Ansari. It is closely related to the discussion of fana'/baqa', and together these two entries provide an overall picture of the Sufi process of spiritual discipline. Cross-cultural comparison with Teresa's seven mansions raises the question of whether Christian and Islamic spirituality are structurally isomorphic.

5.10 Buddhist Stages of Practice - The Ten Bodhisattva Bhumis and the Five Paths

"Buddhist stages of practice - the ten bodhisattva bhumis and the five paths," associated with the *Dasabhumikasutra* (, compiled around the turn of the era), Nagarjuna (c.150-250), and Asanga (c.4th c.), concerns the dasabhumi, the bodhisattva stages in Mahayana Buddhism. They are established in the *Dasabhumikasutra* and as one chapter within the *Avatamsakasutra*. The text is extant in Sanskrit, Chinese translation, and Tibetan translation. The ten bhumis are: (1) (Pramudita), (2) (Vimala), (3) (Prabhakari), (4) (Arcismati), (5) (Sudurjaya), (6) (Abhimukhi), (7) (Durangama), (8) (Acala), (9) (Sadhumati), and (10) (Dharmamegha). A corresponding paramita is assigned to each stage.

The Buddhist stages of practice show strong structural correspondence with the five-stage model. The five paths, panca-marga, provide the most direct correspondence: before the path of accumulation (Field) -> path of accumulation (Wave: the emergence of difference as bodhicitta) -> path of preparation (Edge: the boundary between conceptual and nonconceptual cognition) -> path of seeing (Vortex: a qualitative transformation through the direct experience of emptiness) -> path of cultivation plus path of no-more-learning (Bundle: deepening, stabilization, and completion of the experience). The "four preparations" within the path of preparation - heat, summit, patience, and supreme mundane dharma - are a refined description that unfolds the internal structure of Edge into four stages, making them one of the most structurally detailed descriptions of Edge in D24 as a whole. The direct experience of emptiness at the path of seeing, corresponding to the first bhumi, , clearly fits Vortex as a rupture in the conceptual framework: what had previously been understood dissolves, and a new seeing emerges.

This belongs in the context of Mahayana Buddhist scholasticism. The ten bhumis were established in early Mahayana Buddhism around the turn of the era and received different interpretations in the Yogacara and Madhyamaka traditions. The five paths are widely shared across both schools, although descriptions of the content of each path differ. The Ten Ox-Herding Pictures stand in a complementary relation to this entry as an experiential description in Zen Buddhism: scholastic doctrine describes what occurs, while the Ten Ox-Herding Pictures depict how it is experienced. Cross-cultural comparison with fana'/baqa' and the maqamat of Sufism raises the question of whether the Buddhist path of preparation/path of seeing, the Sufi maqam/fana', and Teresa's fourth/fifth mansions are structurally isomorphic.

6. Cross-Domain Patterns

First, as shown by Rambo's seven-stage model of conversion + dynamic force field, Turner's liminality and structure/anti-structure (communitas), and Teresa of Avila's *El Castillo Interior o Las Moradas*: seven mansions, this domain describes difference and conflict not merely as obstacles but as conditions for the emergence of a new order. This means that, within the five-stage model, the transition from Edge to Vortex is especially richly observable in this domain.

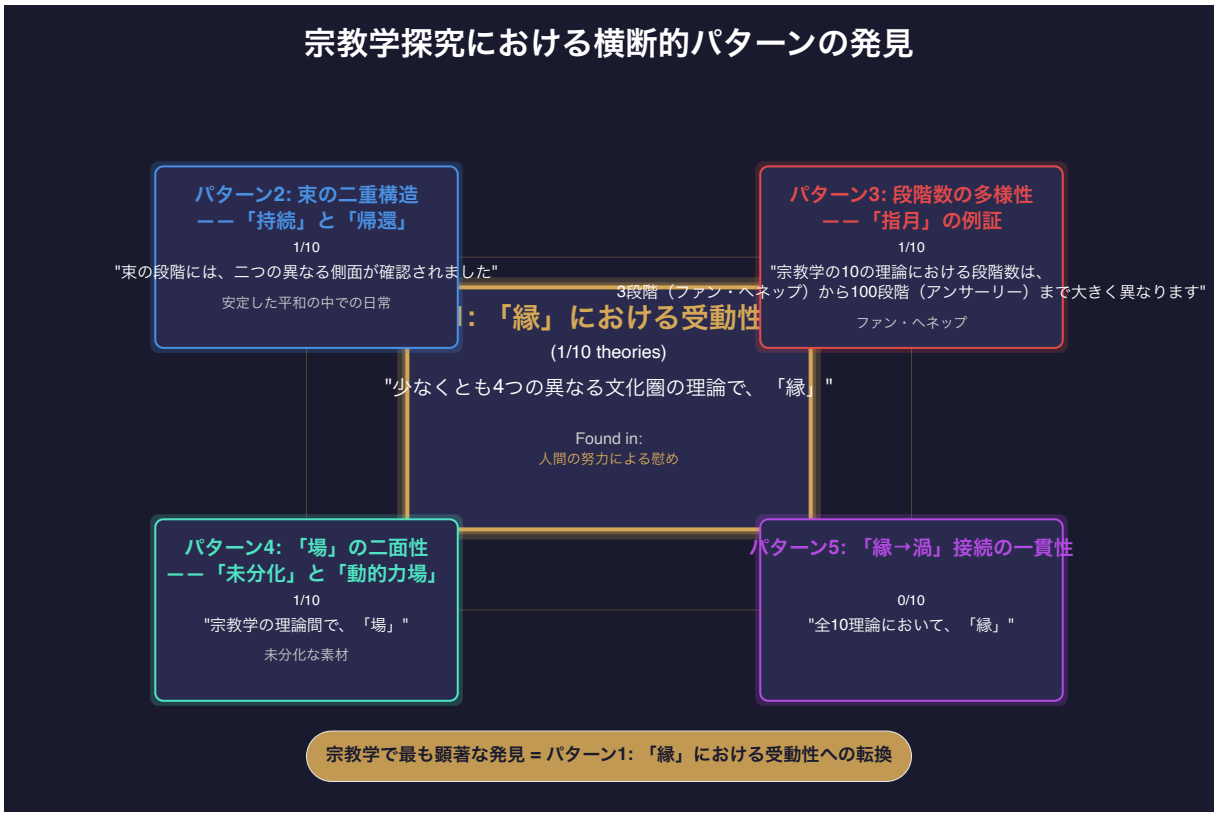

Figure 3: Religion —

Second, what the Ten Ox-Herding Pictures, fana'/baqa' in Sufism, and the alchemical *Magnum Opus* share is that generation is not a one-off event but includes a circulation through the formation of preconditions, the amplification of tension, local ordering, stabilization, and subsequent reconfiguration. This confirms that the five-stage model must be read not as a static table of classification but as a temporal movement.

On the other hand, James's *The Varieties of Religious Experience* also shows that correspondence with the five-stage model does not arise automatically. Similarity in the number of stages or in vocabulary is insufficient; it is necessary to examine in each case which concept bears the turning point and at what level the structure emerges.

7. Unresolved Questions

1. To what extent can James's *The Varieties of Religious Experience* be read as a stage-based description within the five-stage model?
2. How far can the structures confirmed in this domain be extended from the explanation of individual cases into a more general generative model? The conditions under which comparability can be maintained without losing the specificity of the objects still require further scrutiny.
3. Should the five stages be read as a linear progression, or as a circulation that includes multiple temporal layers and repetition? In particular, theories differ in the degree to which they make explicit the return from Bundle to the next Field.
4. What becomes visible, and what is lost, when the vocabulary proper to this domain is translated into the general vocabulary of the five stages? The boundary between translatability and untranslatability is itself an important issue for future comparative

inquiry.

8. Conclusion

This re-examination of the domain confirmed strong structural correspondence in 9 of the 10 theories and conditional correspondence in 1. In particular, Rambo's seven-stage model of conversion + dynamic force field, Turner's liminality and structure/anti-structure (communitas), and Teresa of Avila's *El Castillo Interior o Las Moradas*: seven mansions provide especially thick descriptions either from Field to Edge or from Edge to Vortex, and they therefore count as central evidence within this domain.

At the same time, the findings of this domain do not support the claim that the same five stages simply appear in identical form in every theory. The stages that appear most strongly differ from one theory to another, and some cases require reservations in stage mapping. What matters, therefore, is not to generalize directly from a high correspondence rate, but to continue comparing which phase is described in which vocabulary.

In that sense, this domain not only supports the validity of the five-stage model in one direction but also imposes conditions on how the model should be read. The very fact that the domain contains both theories with thick correspondence and theories that require reservation constitutes part of its value as a comparative investigation.